

Healthcare in prison

Unit 2

Talking about my health



English to help you understand how to get help when you are ill in prison



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People get ill in prison just like they do outside prison. This means you will probably need to see a doctor or someone in healthcare.

Learn some words to talk about how you feel.

Learning goals

By the end of this unit you will be able to:

- use words to describe how you are feeling
- learn the names of some illnesses
- understand questions a healthcare worker will ask you

Task 1 – Health problems

1. Who has a health problem?

Here are two men, Pete and Francis. Tick (✓) who is ill or has a health problem.



☐ Pete



☐ Francis

2. Name the problem (or symptom)

Pete has toothache. It hurts! Write the words from the box under the correct picture on the next page.

a runny nose	asthma	toothache	earache	a sore throat
a headache	a bruise	backache	chest pain	
a swollen ankle	a cough	a high temperature		

		
1.	2.	3. <i>toothache</i> 
		
4.	5.	6.
		
7.	8.	9.
		
10.	11.	12.

Task 2 Read a conversation: speaking to a PID (PID =Prisoner Information Desk)

Man: Hello. I feel ill. Could I see a doctor please?

PID worker: What's the matter?

Man: I've got a bad headache and a sore throat. I want to rest in cell.

PID worker: Have you filled in an app or an application?

Man: No, I haven't. I asked the officer for an app... and he told me to speak to you.

PID worker: OK that's fine. Fill it in now and then put it in the medical box. Write something here too about how you feel.

Man: When can I see a doctor?

PID worker: It depends. If you fill in an app, you will see a doctor as soon as possible.

Man: Thanks for your help.

PID worker: No problem, mate.

Read the conversation and answer the questions. Tick (✓) the answers.

1. What's wrong with the man?

- ☐ He's got toothache
- ☐ He's depressed.
- ☐ He has a headache and sore throat.

2. How can the man get an appointment with a doctor?

- ☐ Fill in a form called an app.
- ☐ Ring the doctor.

3. When can the man see a doctor?

- ☐ Tomorrow.
- ☐ They don't know.

Grammar: have got / has got

He's got a headache and a sore throat.

4. Write the words into the table.

they've	I've	he's	we've	she's	you've
---------	------	------	-------	-------	--------

I have = <i>I've</i> 	got	a	headache.
you have =	got	a	sore throat.
he has =	got	-	earache.
she has =	got	-	asthma.
we have =	got	a	cough.
they have =	got	a	nosebleed.

Grammar: word order

got / a / headache / have / I

I have got a headache. 

He / asthma / got / has

5. _____

nosebleed / got / I / 've / a

6. _____

You / a / cough / 've / got

7. _____

Task 3 – Saying how you feel

What's he saying to the doctor?

1.



I've got *backache*. 

2.



I've got _ _ _ _ _.

3.



I've got a _ _ _ _ _ on my arm.

4.



_ _ _ _ _.

5.



Task 4 – Questions and illnesses

Before you start:

Look at these sentences:

These are **painkillers** or tablets.



Many people have **allergies**. Some people are **allergic to** milk, nuts or bread.



I'm allergic to nuts. I can't eat them. They make me ill.



Do you have any allergies?

Here are some questions a healthcare professional might ask you. Match the question with the answer.

- | | |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. What's the matter? | a. Yes, I took some painkillers. |
| 2. Where does it hurt? | b. Yes, I do. I'm allergic to milk. |
| 3. Have you got a temperature? | c. I feel sick. |
| 4. Have you taken anything? | d. Since Monday. |
| 5. Do you have any allergies? | e. No, I don't think I have. |
| 6. How long have you felt sick? | f. In my neck. |

Task 4b – These men don't feel very well. What's wrong?



Match the sentence with the illness.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. I feel down all the time. | <p>diabetes
depression
asthma
a cold
eye problems</p> |
| 2. I can't see very well. | |
| 3. I feel really weak. I need some sugar. | |
| 4. I can't breathe. | |
| 5. I've got a sore throat and runny nose. | |

Task 5: Health wordsearch

Find these words in the puzzle:

bruise

cold

cough

depression

earache

flu

pain

sick

sore

symptoms

swollen

toothache ✓

s	y	m	p	t	o	m	s
w	d	a	t	o	r	o	o
o	e	z	c	o	l	d	r
l	p	b	y	t	a	q	e
l	r	t	o	h	z	t	i
e	e	i	p	a	i	n	b
n	s	q	b	c	t	y	u
y	s	e	u	h	u	r	t
d	i	a	b	e	t	e	s
s	o	r	w	y	o	r	z
a	n	a	z	b	c	p	b
s	i	c	k	o	o	a	r
b	j	h	i	t	u	u	u
t	r	e	a	t	g	i	i
u	x	b	k	o	h	r	s
f	l	u	r	y	i	y	e

Word list – new words about my health. Add any more new words you have learnt in the spaces at the bottom.

Write the word in your language.

		symptom	translation
I've got	a	headache	
	-	backache	
	-	earache	
	-	stomach ache	
	-	toothache	
	-	chest pain	
	-	diarrhoea	
	a	bruise	
	a	blister	
	a	cough	
	a	runny nose	
	a	swollen ankle	
	a	sore throat	
	a	temperature	
	a	nosebleed	

End of unit check

Now you have finished this unit, how do you feel? Tick (✓) the box that is true for you.

	Yes	A little	No
I can use words to describe how I am feeling.			
I can say the names of some illnesses.			
I can understand questions a healthcare worker will ask me			

Answer key: Workbook 2 – Talking about your health ()

Task 1

1. Pete

1.2

1. earache
2. asthma
3. a runny nose
4. a sore throat
5. toothache
6. chest pain
7. backache
8. a swollen ankle
9. a headache
10. a cough
11. a bruise
12. a high temperature

Task 2

1. He has a headache and sore throat.
2. Fill in a form called an app.
3. They don't know.
4. you've, he's, she's, we've, they've
5. He has got asthma.
6. I've got a nosebleed.
7. You've got a cough.

Task 3

1. I've got backache.
2. I've got a sore throat.
3. I've got a bruise.
4. I've got a toothache.
5. I've got a swollen ankle.

Task 4

1. c
2. f
3. e
4. a
5. b
6. d

Task 4b

1. depression
2. eye problems
3. diabetes
4. asthma
5. a cold

Task 5

s	y	m	p	t	o	m	s
w	d	a	t	o	r	o	o
o	e	z	c	o	l	d	r
l	p	b	y	t	a	q	e
l	r	t	o	h	z	t	i
e	e	i	p	a	i	n	b
n	s	q	b	c	t	y	u
y	s	e	u	h	u	r	t
d	i	a	b	e	t	e	s
s	o	r	w	y	o	r	z
a	n	a	z	b	c	p	b
s	i	c	k	o	o	a	r
b	j	h	i	t	u	u	u
t	r	e	a	t	g	i	i
u	x	b	k	o	h	r	s
f	l	u	r	y	i	y	e